Assessment comments

Example 1: SLP2

Subject: Economics

Component: SL paper 2

Question 2 Part	Marks awarded	Marks available	Comments
(a)(i)	2	2	This is an unnecessarily long and complex definition. However, all the required elements are present. • "Output" implies goods/services. • The addition of "final income" implies some notion of value.
(a)(ii)	0	2	Neither the indicator nor the dimension is mentioned in the answer.
(b)(i)	0	3	The final answer is incorrect, and the working is not correct either (one component of the current account is missing).
(b)(ii)	2	2	The correct value to two decimal points and the working are provided.
(c)	4	4	Two marks are allotted for the diagram and two marks for the explanation. The diagram is correct and fully labelled. The notion of currencies being exchanged for international transactions (exports) is clearly explained.
(d)	4	4	Two marks are allotted for the diagram and two marks for the explanation. The diagram is correct and fully labelled. Aggregate supply or "AS" is a valid label for short-run aggregate supply. A link is established between fuel as a factor of production and firms' costs of production.
(e)	3	4	Two marks are allotted for the diagram and one mark for the explanation. The required elements of "low income" and "low investment" are included. This poverty cycle also shows logical progression (it is clear how one element may link to another). Possible increases in skill set/productivity are pointed out, but this is not tied adequately to the provision of education.
(f)	4	4	Two marks are allotted for the diagram and two marks for the explanation. The diagram is fully labelled and shows the increase in supply together with the changes in market outcomes (higher quantity and lower price). The candidate explains that adopting new farming practices would increase efficiency (implying "greater productivity"), resulting in a higher quantity and lower price for rice. The candidate points out that technological improvements is a non-price determinant of supply, and this would have also sufficed as justification for the increase in supply.

Question 2 Part	Marks awarded	Marks available	Comments
(g)	7	15	The level descriptors are as noted below. • Demands of the question (borderline, between the four-to-six and seven-to-nine markbands): The candidate seems to understand the concepts of growth and development since barriers to growth and development are identified. However, it is not clear how intervention may help overcome them and thus the requirements of the question are only partially addressed. • Theory (four-to-six markband): The links to growth and development are not well explained. Some potentially good arguments are made, such as (price) volatility and the lack of diversification, but these are not fully explained. • Terms (seven-to-nine markband): There is evidence of adequate use of terms, but this is not sustained throughout the response. Some terms, such as "foreign direct investment", are also misused. • Diagram(s) (borderline, between the four-to-six and seven-to-nine markbands): A diagram is included but not explained. • Evaluation (four-to-six markband): There is a superficial attempt at evaluation (e.g., foreign aid is not sustainable in the long term). • Use of text (seven-to-nine markband): Information from the text is used but not effectively. For instance, the information pointing to the lack of diversification and volatility is not used effectively to formulate convincing arguments. This response meets some of the descriptors in the four-to-six markband and some in the seven-to-nine markband, and thus the grade must minimally go beyond 6. However, as the use of diagrams is very weak and the question is generally left unanswered, some of the descriptors in the seven-to-nine markband lean slightly towards the lower range. Thus, a mark of seven is awarded.
Total	**26**	**40**	